control but coexist with what is by many definitions a complex organism unto itself. But where are the brains of this organism?

Years into the technology explosion we still have the same approach towards hardware and platforms to run our advanced software. Mainframes are still bulky and expensive to maintain and a computer with processing speed in Teraflops is still inaccessible to an average individual.

This was perhaps the problem statement that challenged the people at Amazon back in 2006. Hence Amazon Web Services (AWS) was formed, with a singular purpose to overcome the limitations of physical infrastructure and provide the ease and flexibility of cloud based managed services and platforms. AWS has evolved into a multi-billion dollar subsidiary of Amazon. Today it has well over a thousand services offered on its platform ranging from a simple Virtual Machine (VM) to an incredibly powerful video analysis tool.

Developers are no longer limited to ideas that are feasible only on minimal hardware and can rent very powerful machines and pay for the them by usage or by the hour solving problems that would not have been conceivable a few years ago. Entrepreneurs likewise, do not need to wait for a technical implementation of an idea (that can take months if not years), but can simply use one of the managed services on offer.

The AWS TimeLine:

2006

- AWS releases with Simple Storage Service (S3).
- Simple Queue Service (SQS) is released in production.
- Amazon launches Amazon Elastic Compute Cloud (EC2), allowing users to rent virtual computers on which to run their own computer applications.

2007

- Amazon goes global, launches S3 in Europe, reducing latency and bandwidth for European users.

2008

- AWS launches Amazon CloudFront, a content delivery network (CDN).

2009

- Amazon launches Amazon Elastic MapReduce, which allows researchers, data analysts, and developers to easily process vast amounts of data.